01 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Choose a question the prototype can expose.

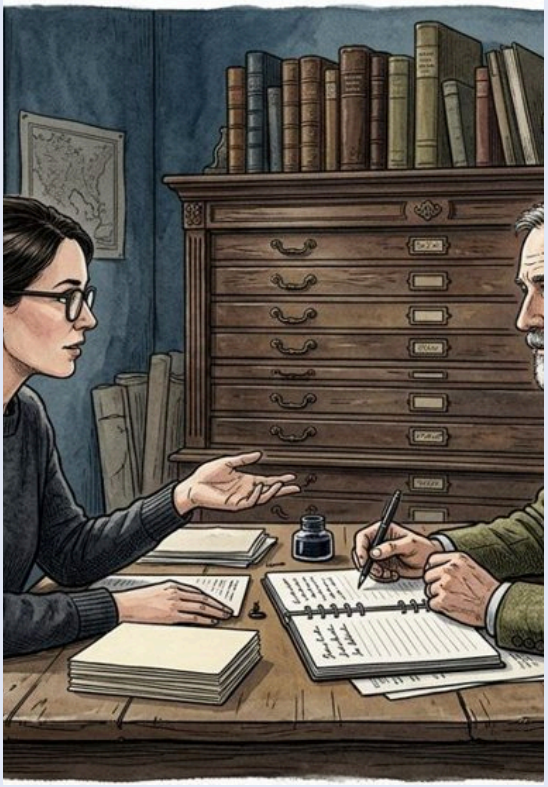


Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

This plan asks whether an invented Context Card lets a reader explain a note's source relationship and the available context change. It is a plan for inquiry, not a completed usability report.

Three tasks are crossed with three observation checkpoints. All nine cells are unrecorded. No participant identities, recruitment, session dates or results are supplied.

Study intention

The intended output is a traceable record of what an actual artifact might reveal under a bounded task. It is not a success-rate target.

OBSERVATION CELL

T01 / first-interpretation

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

Question	Scope	Current
How is the note-source relationship interpreted?	A future walkthrough of a clearly labeled paper concept.	Three tasks, nine empty cells and no actual sessions.

Which uncertainty requires observation rather than another opinion?

02 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Describe what the prototype cannot do.

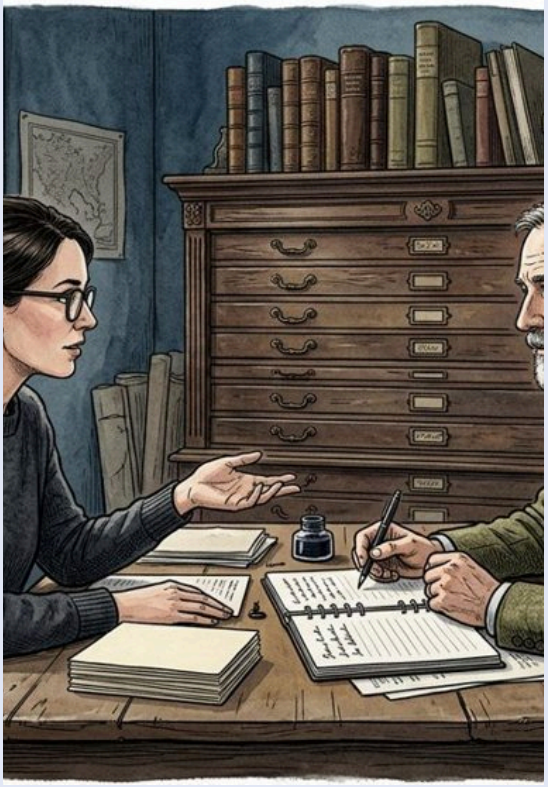


Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

The paper concept represents a note, its source reference and alternate context panels. It has no live save, network retrieval, authentication or assistive-technology implementation.

A facilitator may substitute an authored panel after a participant describes an intended action, if that procedure is explained. The substitution is not a working response-time or reliability test.

Fidelity boundary

Do not interpret a missing implementation as a participant error. Separate artifact limitations, task ambiguity and observed interaction difficulty.

OBSERVATION CELL

T01 / attempted-action

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

Represents	Does not run	Procedure
Content grouping and proposed context states.	Saving, source retrieval or a real navigation service.	Any panel substitution must be explained and recorded.

Could a result be caused by the prototype's limitation?

03 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Set a scenario without teaching the cue.



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Invite a future participant to imagine returning to a note written beside an invented passage. Ask what the note refers to before pointing to the source reference or expansion action.

The scenario must not imply that a good reader will choose a particular route. Participation and recording arrangements must be established for a real study; this template grants no permission to collect data.

Scenario setup

Use non-sensitive invented material. Avoid requiring personal reading history or private documents merely to make a task feel realistic.

OBSERVATION CELL

T01 / unresolved-question

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

Context	Material	Choice
Return to an authored note after a fictional interval.	Use the same invented passage and note across tasks.	Any real participation or recording needs a separate arrangement.

Does the setup reveal the answer it is meant to investigate?

04 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Give each task an inspectable goal.



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

T01 asks the reader to explain which passage the note concerns. T02 asks how they would reveal more context. T03 asks what they would do when context is unavailable.

Read one task at a time without naming the intended control. The script records a goal and a boundary, not a compulsory sequence or a declared success event.

Task scripts

A participant may choose a route the designer did not anticipate. Record the route before deciding whether the task or artifact needs revision.

OBSERVATION CELL

T02 / first-interpretation

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

T01	T02	T03
Explain which source passage the note concerns.	Describe how to reveal more of the note's context.	Explain the next step when context is unavailable.

Can the goal be understood without a button name?

05 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Separate observation from interpretation.



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

The checkpoints are first interpretation, attempted action and unresolved question. A permitted record should capture what happened at each checkpoint before explaining why it may have happened.

Do not infer confusion from a pause without further context. A quiet reader, an incomplete paper panel and an unclear task can produce similar outward behavior for different reasons.

Observation vocabulary

Keep quotations distinct from paraphrases and mark any facilitator intervention. The source matrix currently contains neither quotations nor observed actions.

OBSERVATION CELL

T02 / attempted-action

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

First interpretation	Attempted action	Unresolved question
Record the initial explanation in permitted form.	Record the action or described intention and any intervention.	Record what remains uncertain without inventing a cause.

Could another researcher distinguish the event from its explanation?

06 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Leave unobserved cells genuinely empty.



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

The matrix crosses T01, T02 and T03 with the three checkpoints, yielding nine planned cells. Each has status unrecorded and a null observation; none means a failed task.

Do not fill empty cells with plausible behavior to make the report look finished. A real session may produce no relevant observation at a checkpoint, which should be represented explicitly and separately.

Recording matrix

A future record needs task, artifact version, session reference and an appropriate permission basis. This workbook contains no actual session identifiers.

OBSERVATION CELL

T02 / unresolved-question

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

Rows	Values	Meaning
Three task IDs, each with three planned checkpoints.	All nine observations remain null and unrecorded.	Absence of a record is not failure, zero time or dissatisfaction.

Can an empty field be mistaken for a result?

07 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Cluster only after preserving the source records.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Potential themes might concern source association, action wording or unavailable-context explanation. These are planning categories, not findings derived from participants.

A real synthesis should retain links to the observations it groups, preserve exceptions and distinguish artifact issues from task-script issues. Frequency alone cannot establish severity without context.

Issue synthesis

Do not report that most people struggled when no sessions occurred. Avoid inventing severity ratings or completion percentages from an empty matrix.

OBSERVATION CELL

T03 / first-interpretation

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

Candidate theme	Evidence state	Rule
Source relationship may require a clearer explanation.	No observed records support or contradict that possibility.	Preserve traceable exceptions rather than forcing every note into a theme.

What observation would support the proposed theme?

08 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Connect a revision to a specific uncertainty.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

If a future record suggests the source relation is unclear, a revised panel could change the reference placement while keeping wording constant. That is a proposed next comparison, not a validated fix.

Record the version difference and the question it addresses. Changing task wording, content and layout at once can obscure what explains an observed difference.

Iteration plan

A cleaner drawing is not evidence of improved usability. Any claim about improvement needs an appropriate comparison and a transparent boundary.

OBSERVATION CELL

T03 / attempted-action

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

Hypothetical change	Control	Status
Adjust reference placement without changing note wording.	Retain the same passage and task goal.	No actual issue, revision result or measured improvement exists.

What would a follow-up task distinguish?

09 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Make the limitations part of the result format.



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Even a completed small walkthrough would be bounded by its artifact, tasks, participants and setting. This plan has additional limits because it has not been executed at all.

Paper panels cannot establish persistence, live latency, keyboard operation or assistive-technology behavior. No claim about a population, business outcome or accessibility conformance follows from this plan.

Study limits

Keep missing evidence visible in the handoff. A reader should not have to infer that a polished matrix is empty of participant data.

OBSERVATION CELL

T03 / unresolved-question

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

Not measured	Not tested	Not inferred
Task completion, time, error rate or satisfaction.	Live behavior, keyboard access or assistive technology.	Population preference, adoption or business value.

Which conclusion is outside the method's reach?

10 / PROTOTYPE STUDY

Prepare the next study without announcing findings.



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

The next step is to review the task script and the paper panels for misleading cues, then establish a real participation and recording process if the study proceeds.

Keep the unrecorded matrix as a planning fixture. Any future data must be versioned and sourced rather than silently overwriting null cells while retaining this document's claim that no sessions occurred.

Research handoff

Share the question, artifact limits, task goals and observation vocabulary together. A successor should know both what to collect and what not to conclude.

OBSERVATION CELL

T01 / first-interpretation

STUDY BOUNDARY

3 tasks × 3 checkpoints; 9 unrecorded cells. No participant data.

TASK / CHECKPOINT / OBSERVATION

Prepare	**Arrange**	**Preserve**
Review task wording and clearly label the paper concept.	Establish actual participation, recording and data-handling terms.	Version the fixture before adding real observations.

What is required before any cell becomes evidence?